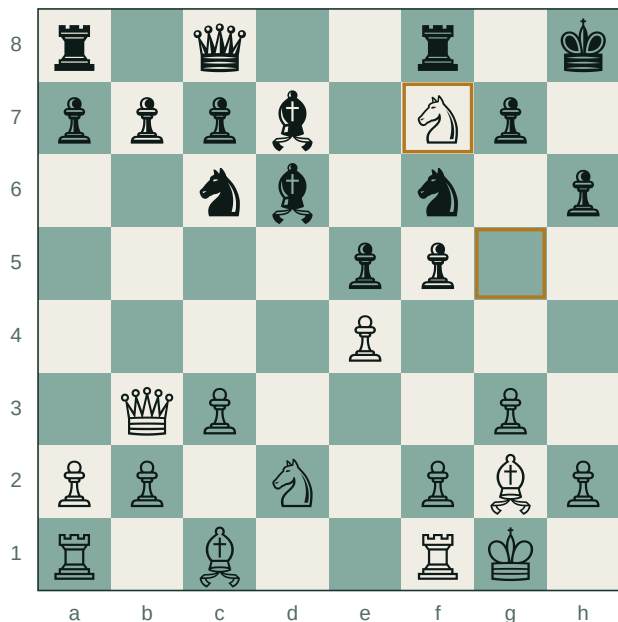


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 13

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 13.Nf7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

13...Rxf7 14. Qxf7 Be6 15. Qxf6 gxf6

13...Rxf7 The rook captures the knight on f7. Recorded reply: **14.Qxf7**.

14...Be6 The bishop moves from d7 to e6. Recorded reply: **15.Qxf6**.

15...gxf6 The pawn captures the queen on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 26 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.